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Speech Contest Announcement

SCCS' 7th Chinese Speech Contest will be held on Sunday, **December 16, 2012**, in East Lyme High School Auditorium from **10:00 AM to 1:00 PM**.

Although participation is not mandatory, we highly encourage our students to participate. Past participants can attest that participating in SCCS Speech Contest is a fun and exciting experience. They also said that preparation itself is a memorable learning process. Many past award winners carried their enthusiasm in Chinese learning on to becoming SCCS event hosts and hostesses, to earn perfect scores in Chinese SAT and AP, and to become student teachers at SCCS now!

You may choose a topic most familiar to you, such as My School, My Home, My Trip to China, etc. Or, be creative! Surprise us with your language talent. Talk to your teachers, your parents, and your friends to get the best idea for your presentation. We are looking forward to seeing the best of you!

- ◆ Three new teachers have joined SCCS lately. They are Ms. Yujuan Zhai teaching Chinese book four, Ms. Helen Xiong teaching CMC, and Ms. Zhe Jiang teaching Chinese Book eight. They used to teach Chinese language in New Jersey, Hartford, and Florida, respectively.
- ◆ SCCS closed all its activities on November 4th due to Hurricane Sandy. The class will be made up on April 14, 2013.

社区新闻



HAPPY



THANKSGIVING

- ◆ SCCS held a Chinese language teacher training session in East Lyme Community Center on November 11. Ms. Yujuan Zhai, Ms. Yinyu Tu and Ms. Yanqiao Xiang presented three different topics.

- ◆ SCCS successfully held a fire drill on November 11.

- ◆ Two school principals from Shandong, China, visited East Lyme and Old Lyme Schools. Ms. Lain-Yen Hu, SCCS Chinese teacher, served as an interpreter during their visit. The two principals also met part of SCCS board members, teachers, and PTA members to share teaching experiences, etc.

(MS. Yinyu Tu)

长风破浪会有时，直挂云帆济沧海

MESSAGES FROM SCCS ALUMNI

Shanghai, China: Shuling Wu Ms. Shuling Wu, SCCS Chinese teacher, has gone to Shanghai to continue her career at Pfizer Shanghai CRDC. Ms. Wu loved teaching Chinese at our school and was very active in our community. Since she joined SCCS in 2009, she has taught Chinese from grades one to three. She once said that teaching at SCCS was one of her fondest memories and the most enjoyable work. She also said that she will miss SCCS students and teachers; many of them she knows well.

While we send our best wishes to her in her new endeavor in Shanghai, we hope she can return to southeastern Connecticut and work with us again at SCCS in the future.

(Mr. Lin Shu)



Ms. Shuling Wu & Peiran Li

Boston: Qian Lin Time flies. It has been almost five months since my family moved to the Greater Boston area. I am still working for Pfizer, but not in Groton site. Instead, I am now working in the Cambridge site located in the campus of famous ivy school - MIT. At work breaks, I often walk along banks of the Charles River, which always makes me think of the Thames River in Groton and my past walks along its banks. Living and working in a metropolitan such as Boston is quite different

from living and working in the countryside of south-east of Connecticut. Now bus and subway rides are my daily routine. Sitting in a bustling crowd in bus and subway, reading morning metro news tabloid has become a part of my daily routine.

There is an old Chinese saying: Man Eats by Nature. This is especially true for overseas Chinese like us. I am so grateful that Boston is such a great place for Chinese food. I have been exploring quite a few Chinese restaurants in Boston area. I wish you all have the opportunities to visit Boston and I will be more than happy to introduce you to the best Chinese restaurants.

I started missing the teachers, students and friends of the SCCS, so much so that I thought about going back and resuming my precious SCCS teaching position. For now, I am a substitute Chinese teacher at both Winchester and Newton Chinese Schools. I appreciate the greetings and caring from you to those of us who have left SCCS. I will do my best to support the SCCS, as it gave me so much.....

(Ms. Qian Lin)



Ms. Qian Lin & Ms. Linyan He

SNAPSHOTS OF TEACHER TRAINING

Our previous training sessions were mainly focused on teaching methodologies, classroom management, and program design. This year, the focus is shifted to discussion on Chinese grammatical theories and appreciation of Chinese culture.

The session started with an introduction of modern Chinese grammar, semantics, and pragmatics by Ms. Yinyu Tu. Ms. Tu attended an intensive Chinese language training session at Huaqiao University in Fujian Province, China during the summer. In our training session, she used quite a few examples to explain the concepts and interrelationship of modern Chinese grammar, semantics and pragmatics. We are told that increasing semantic and pragmatic explanation when teaching Chinese grammar is at the cutting edge research of modern Chinese teaching and will facilitate the learning process.



Ms. Yinyu Tu in Training Session

Next, Ms. Yanqiao Xiang's "how to use a sound recorder for teaching and homework assignments" was presented. What her presentation told us is that the sound recorder in a PC can be utilized to record the teacher's reading of the homework assignments for the students to follow and be sent to students. Students also may record their reading and send back to the teacher. The clever use of technology can improve learning efficiency and enhance student's

learning interest. We highly recommend our teachers to adopt the latest technologies in their teaching.

Lastly, Ms. Yujuan Zhai, demonstrated traditional Chinese painting. She began with a brief introduction of traditional Chinese painting and its essential materials. Then, she painted a plum flower, a favor-



Ms. Yujuan Zhai Drawing Chinese Painting

ite by many Chinese scholars. Her amazing skills and beautiful painting brought rounds of applause from the fellow teachers. Even more amazing is her "blow painting" technique! Pouring ink on a sheet of paper, she blew the ink into different directions, and eventually made a plum flower with a decoration of a few red flower buds. Under her instruction, every teacher blew his or her own plum flowers. Ms. Zhai's unique "blow painting" totally grabbed every teacher's attention, and would do so for students, had it been applied to our Chinese teaching and classroom management. This makes us think that other kinds of traditional Chinese arts such as paper-cut and gourd painting can also be utilized in our classrooms. In order to do so, our

teachers themselves should have a considerable understanding of many kinds of Chinese culture in addition to mastering the Chinese language.

(Mr. Xun Pei)



PHOTOS OF COMMUNITY ACTIVITIES



Blow Painting from Training Session



*Teachers in Discussion
on Training Session*



Group Photo with Shandong Principals

**HAPPY
HOLIDAYS**

***To all of you,
Happy Holidays and
Best Wishes!***



Nov. 11th — Fire Drill



Sep. 29th— Mid-Autumn Day Party